After Akbar came Jahangir. He resumed the tradition of patronage for Hajj. An amount of Rs 2 lakh was allocated for Hajj.[§] He has mentioned it in his autobiography, *Tarikh-i-Salim Shahi*:[¶]

> During the reign of my father, the ministers of religion and students of law and literature, to the number of two and three thousand, in the principal cities of the empire, were already allowed pensions from the state; and to these, in conformity with the regulations established by my father, I directed Miran Sadr Jahan one of the noblest among the Seyeds of Herat, to allot a subsistence corresponding with their situation; and this is not only to the subjects of my own realms, but to foreigners – to natives of Persia, Roum, Bokhara, and Azerbaijan, with strict charge that this class of men should not be permitted either want or inconvenience of any type.

Despite having claimed to be highly non-religious in nature, Jahangir too did his part of sending out Indian wealth to Mecca. He had sent an amber candlestick covered with a network of gold, ornamented with gems and diamonds by his artisans of the court. The cost of this beautiful piece as per records was Rs 2.50 lakh.[*] In AD 1650, a diamond-studded candlestick along with a 300-carat diamond was sent to Mecca.[†]

If we move further, Aurangzeb can be deemed one of the grandest donors for Muslim lands. Between AD 1661 and AD 1667, Aurangzeb welcomed the kings of Persia, Bukhara, Kashgar, Balkh, Urganj, and Shahr-i-Nau and the Turkish governors of Basra (in Iraq).

Sir Richard Burn, the editor of *Cambridge History of India*, has stated:[‡]

> His policy was to dazzle the eyes of these princes by lavish gift of presents to them and to their envoys, and thus induce the outer Muslim world to forget his treatment of his father and brothers. The fame of India as a soft milch cow spread throughout the middle and near East, and the minor embassies were merely begging expeditions.

Records state that around Rs 30 lakh were spent by Aurangzeb between AD 1661 and AD 1667. He had also distributed a large sum annually at Mecca. He had sent a gift of Rs 10 lakh to Abdullah Khān. He was the deposed king of Kashgar and had been granted refuge by Aurangzeb in AD 1668.[§]

The cashflow to Mecca continued flawlessly under Aurangzeb through his agents. It is very interesting to note that this wealth export of Tīmūrids was a one-way street. Nothing substantial came as a return. This is very well described by the seventeenth-century travelogue of François Bernier.

In AD 1664, the Christian monarch of Ethiopia sent an embassy to Aurangzeb. The embassy was represented by two ambassadors. One of them was Murat, an Armenian Christian while the other one was a Muslim merchant